

Average Car Payment and Auto Loan Statistics: 2026



Written by [Maggie Gunara](#)

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Why use LendingTree?



The average monthly payment for a new vehicle was \$765 in the second quarter of 2026, up 2.1% from a year earlier.

Average monthly payments for used and leased vehicles reached \$542 and \$617, respectively, rising 1.9% and 0.7% year over year.

LendingTree analyzed payments, loan originations, term lengths, delinquencies and other data to provide a comprehensive snapshot of U.S. auto loan debt and lending trends.

Here are the key auto loan statistics for 2026.

Key findings

- Average monthly payments for new, used and leased vehicles increased year over year.** According to Experian, the average new-vehicle payment rose 2.1% from the second quarter of 2025 to the second quarter of 2026. During the same period, average payments for used vehicles and vehicle leases increased by 1.9% and 0.7%, respectively. Average monthly payments reached \$765 for new vehicles, \$542

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for used vehicles and \$617 for new-vehicle leases.

- ✓ **New-vehicle prices increased, while used-vehicle prices declined.** According to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) July 2026 consumer price index (CPI), new-vehicle prices rose 0.5% year over year, while used-vehicle prices fell 1.9%. Experian data shows that Americans borrow an average of \$43,610 for new vehicles and \$27,852 for used vehicles.
- ✓ **Auto loan debt is the second-largest category of consumer debt after mortgages.** According to the Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Americans owe \$1.713 trillion in auto loan debt, representing 9.1% of total consumer debt.
- ✓ **Americans originated \$210.8 billion in new auto loans in the second quarter of 2026.** According to the New York Fed, borrowers ages 18 to 49 accounted for \$129.3 billion of that total, compared with \$81.2 billion among borrowers ages 50 and older.
- ✓ **Auto loan repayment terms remain lengthy.** According to Experian, the average term is 69.5 months for new-vehicle loans, 67.9 months for used-vehicle loans and 35.9 months for new-vehicle leases.
- ✓ **90-day auto loan delinquency rates increased from a year earlier.** According to the New York Fed, 5.5% of outstanding auto debt was at least 90 days delinquent in the second quarter of 2026, up 10.0% from a year earlier. Meanwhile, 7.9% of auto loans became 30 days past due in the second quarter of 2026, down 1.1% from the second quarter of 2025.
- ✓ **Borrowers with prime and super-prime credit scores account for most retail vehicle financing.** According to Experian, borrowers with credit scores of 661 or higher account for 71.7% of retail vehicle financing, compared with 13.0% for subprime and deep-subprime borrowers with credit scores of 600 or lower.

✔ The **Ford F-150**, **Chevrolet Silverado 1500** and **Toyota Camry** were the vehicle models most frequently considered by consumers on the LendingTree platform in the second quarter of 2026. The F-150 ranked first for the third consecutive quarter.

Average monthly vehicle payments rise year over year

According to Experian data for the second quarter of 2026, the average monthly payment for new vehicles was \$765, up 2.1% from a year earlier. The average monthly payment for a used vehicle was \$542, a 1.9% increase over the same period. Meanwhile, the average monthly payment on a new-vehicle lease was \$617, up 0.7% year over year.

Annual changes in average monthly car payments

Vehicle purchase type	Q2 2025	Q2 2026	Difference (\$)	Difference (%)
New vehicles	\$749	\$765	\$16	2.1%
Used vehicles	\$532	\$542	\$10	1.9%
New vehicle leases	\$613	\$617	\$4	0.7%

Source: Experian State of the Automotive Finance Market, Q2 2025 and Q2 2026.

Borrowers with credit scores of 601 to 660 (nonprime) and 501 to 600 (subprime) make the highest average monthly payments on new vehicles, at \$816 and \$805, respectively.

Average monthly car payments by credit score range

Credit score range	New vehicles	Used vehicles	New leased vehicles
All	\$765	\$542	\$617
781 to 850	\$741	\$534	\$622

Credit score range	New vehicles	Used vehicles	New leased vehicles
661 to 780	\$770	\$528	\$609
601 to 660	\$816	\$555	\$623
501 to 600	\$805	\$567	\$619
300 to 500	\$779	\$570	\$605

Source: Experian State of the Automotive Finance Market, Q2 2026.



Tip

Use the LendingTree auto loan calculator to [estimate your monthly vehicle payment](#).

New-vehicle prices rise while used-vehicle prices fall

According to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) [July 2026 consumer price index \(CPI\) \(opens in a new tab\)](#), new-vehicle prices increased 0.5% year over year. Meanwhile, used-vehicle prices declined 1.9% from a year earlier, offering some relief for consumers shopping for used cars and trucks.

Average new-vehicle loan approaches \$44,000

According to Experian, the average auto loan amount in the second quarter of 2026 was \$43,610 for new vehicles and \$27,852 for used vehicles. The average new-vehicle loan declined by \$56 from the previous quarter, while the average used-vehicle loan increased by \$646.

Among new-vehicle buyers, borrowers in the nonprime credit tier (601 to 660) take out the largest loans, averaging \$46,079. For used vehicles, borrowers in the super-prime

credit tier (781 to 850) have the largest average loan amount, at \$29,937.

Average auto loans by credit score range

Credit score range	New vehicles	Used vehicles
All	\$43,610	\$27,852
781 to 850	\$41,667	\$29,937
661 to 780	\$45,958	\$29,090
601 to 660	\$46,079	\$26,960
501 to 600	\$41,019	\$23,777
300 to 500	\$36,713	\$22,071

Source: Experian State of the Automotive Finance Market, Q2 2026.

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5,000

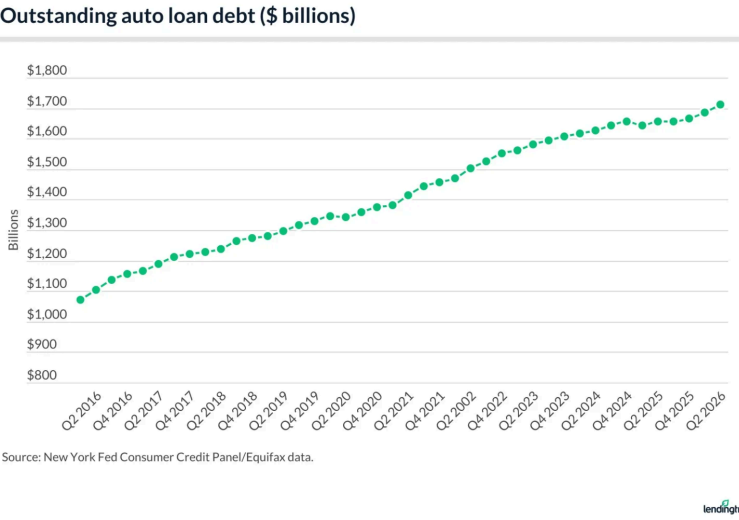
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Americans owe \$1.713 trillion in auto loan debt

According to the Federal Reserve Bank of New York, outstanding auto loan debt increased 55.3% between the second quarter of 2016 and the second quarter of 2026, rising from \$1.103 trillion to \$1.713 trillion.

During that period, a quarter-over-quarter decline occurred in the second quarter of 2020, the first full quarter affected by the COVID-19 pandemic. Another decline occurred between Q4 2024 and Q1 2025. Auto loan debt was unchanged between the second and third quarters of 2025 before resuming its upward trend in the fourth quarter of 2025 and continuing to rise through the second quarter of 2026.



Outstanding auto debt

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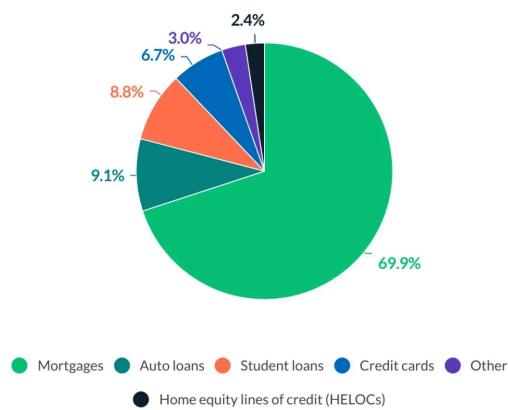
Quarter	Outstanding auto debt (trillions)
Q2 2026	\$1.713
Q1 2026	\$1.685
Q4 2025	\$1.667
Q3 2025	\$1.655
Q2 2025	\$1.655
Q1 2025	\$1.642
Q4 2024	\$1.655
Q3 2024	\$1.644
Q2 2024	\$1.626
Q1 2024	\$1.616

Source: New York Fed Consumer Credit Panel/Equifax data.

Auto loans account for 9.1% of consumer debt

According to the New York Fed, mortgages make up the largest share of U.S. consumer debt at 69.9%, while auto loans account for 9.1%. As of the second quarter of 2026, outstanding auto loan debt totaled \$1.713 trillion, exceeding the \$1.651 trillion in student loan debt.

Distribution of American consumer debt



Source: New York Fed Consumer Credit Panel/Equifax data from Q2 2026. Note: Totals don't add to 100% due to rounding.

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Americans originated \$210.8 billion in auto loans in Q2 2026

Americans originated \$148.9 billion in [auto loans](#) in the second quarter of 2016. By the second quarter of 2026, that figure had risen to \$210.8 billion, according to the New York Fed.

The table below shows quarterly auto loan originations over the period:

Quarterly volume of auto loan originations

Search:

Quarter	Auto loan originations (billions)
Q2 2026	\$210.8
Q1 2026	\$182.1
Q4 2025	\$180.8
Q3 2025	\$183.9
Q2 2025	\$187.9

Quarter	Auto loan originations (billions)
Q1 2025	\$165.6
Q4 2024	\$175.1
Q3 2024	\$184.2
Q2 2024	\$179.1
Q1 2024	\$165.5

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Source: New York Fed Consumer Credit Panel/Equifax data.

Americans in their 30s and 40s originate the most auto loan debt

According to the New York Fed, borrowers in their 30s and 40s originated the largest amounts of auto loan debt in the second quarter of 2026, totaling \$47.7 billion and \$49.8 billion, respectively.

Borrowers in their 50s originated \$39.1 billion in auto loan debt, while those ages 18 to 29 originated \$31.7 billion.

Borrowers in their 60s originated \$26.1 billion, and those 70 and older originated \$16.0 billion.

 Auto loan quarterly originations by borrower age (\$
billions).

Combined, Americans ages 18 to 49 took out \$129.3 billion in auto debt in Q2 2026. That compares with \$81.2 billion among borrowers ages 50 and older.

Borrowers with the highest credit scores account for the largest share of auto loan originations

Borrowers with the highest credit scores continue to account for the largest volume of auto loan originations. In the second quarter of 2026, borrowers with credit scores of 720 or higher originated \$109.2 billion in auto loan debt. According to the New York Fed, all other credit tiers accounted for \$101.6 billion.

Auto loan originations by credit score

Quarter	Less than 620	620 to 659	660 to 719	720 to 759	760+
Q2 2026	\$34.0 billion	\$27.5 billion	\$40.1 billion	\$23.1 billion	\$86.1 billion
Q1 2026	\$28.4 billion	\$21.5 billion	\$32.7 billion	\$21.4 billion	\$78.0 billion
Q4 2025	\$31.8 billion	\$17.5 billion	\$37.3 billion	\$26.2 billion	\$68.1 billion
Q3 2025	\$27.6 billion	\$17.5 billion	\$35.8 billion	\$29.6 billion	\$73.4 billion

Quarter	Less than 620	620 to 659	660 to 719	720 to 759	760+
Q2 2025	\$30.4 billion	\$17.7 billion	\$36.1 billion	\$28.6 billion	\$75.1 billion

Source: New York Fed Consumer Credit Panel/Equifax data.

Average auto loan terms remain lengthy

According to Experian, the average term for a new-vehicle loan is 69.5 months. Used-vehicle loans are nearly as long, averaging 67.9 months despite their smaller loan amounts.

Average term lengths by credit score range

Credit score range	New vehicle loans	Used vehicle loans	New leased vehicles
All	69.5	67.9	35.9
781 to 850	64.9	66.0	35.5
661 to 780	72.4	68.9	36.1
601 to 660	75.6	68.9	36.6
501 to 600	74.9	67.3	36.6
300 to 500	73.7	66.1	36.7

Source: Experian State of the Automotive Finance Market, Q2 2026.

New-vehicle loan terms are even longer among nonprime borrowers, exceeding six years on average. Borrowers with credit scores of 601 to 660 have the longest average new-vehicle loan term, at 75.6 months. By comparison, super-prime borrowers with credit scores of 781 to 850 have the shortest average term, at 64.9 months.

“That’s such a long time to be stuck paying for a depreciating asset,” LendingTree chief consumer finance analyst Matt Schulz says. “It can have an enormous impact on a family’s finances. That money going toward a car payment isn’t earning interest and funding your emergency savings, your retirement nest egg, a [mortgage down payment](#) or your kid’s college fund. Yes, our vehicles are important. In much of the

country, you can't get around without one. And, yes, we love fancy new cars, even new-to-us cars. They're fun to drive and show off. However, once that initial glow wears off and you're still making a big monthly payment on that vehicle after five-plus years, it may not seem worth it."

The average term for a new-vehicle lease is 35.9 months.

90-day auto loan delinquency rate eases from record high

According to New York Fed data, the share of auto loan balances that were at least 90 days delinquent previously peaked at 5.3% in the fourth quarter of 2010. That rate reached a record 5.6% in the first quarter of 2026 before easing to 5.5% in the second quarter.

The share of auto loans transitioning into 30-day delinquency peaked at 10.9% in the second quarter of 2009. Beginning in 2011, the rate remained at or below 8.0% until it increased to 8.1% in the third and fourth quarters of 2024. It then eased to 8.0% in the first and second quarters of 2025 before falling to 7.7% in the fourth quarter of 2025 and the first quarter of 2026. The rate increased slightly to 7.9% in the second quarter of 2026.

 Auto loan delinquency rates (percentage of outstanding debt).

Banks and credit unions remain the leading sources of auto financing

As of the second quarter of 2026, banks held the largest share of the auto financing market at 29.5%, followed by credit unions at 22.8% and captive lenders — manufacturers' financing arms — at 18.4%.

[Buy-here, pay-here](#) dealerships accounted for as much as 17.0% of the used-vehicle financing market. By comparison, captive lenders represented just 6.4% of used-vehicle financing.

 Percentage of loans by lender type.

Schulz — also the author of “Ask Questions, Save Money, Make More: How to Take Control of Your Financial Life” — cautions that buy-here, pay-here financing can carry significant risks. Vehicle prices may be higher, interest rates can resemble credit card rates rather than traditional auto loan rates, and borrowers may face additional fees. Some lenders also require more frequent payments than the standard monthly schedule. In some cases, dealers may require tracking devices that can help locate or repossess vehicles if payments are missed.

For many borrowers, these loans are best viewed as a last-resort financing option, though available choices often depend on credit history and credit score.

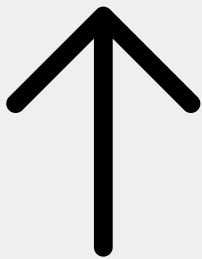
“Good credit means more good options, and that’s a big deal,” Schulz says. “You must shop around. If you finance through the car seller, you’re very likely to overpay. Use sites to compare auto loan offers easily. You could also visit multiple lenders online on your own — consider looking at credit unions if you do. Once you’ve found a deal you’re happy with, [get preapproved by the lender](#). That preapproval gives you leverage over the car seller because they know you won’t be happy with a bad offer.”

Sources

- Experian
- U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

- [Federal Reserve Bank of New York](#)
- [LendingTree](#)

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